Islip Invitational - Repaired practice edition - Answer key

Division C | Disease Detectives | Repair appendix

This appendix contains authored replacements and supplied written alternatives. It does not reconstruct unpublished historical material. For the listed item IDs, use this appendix instead of the archived wording and key.

ANSWER KEY - Review only after submitting.

4. (6 points) Authored replacement for source item Question 4: Solve this case and explain your reasoning: Investigators interview every attendee on a banquet roster after an outbreak and compare illness by food consumed. Identify the design.

reasoning: Selection is based on banquet attendance, not illness status.
Exposure and outcome are reconstructed for the full defined cohort.
Food-specific risks and RR can be estimated if ascertainment and denominators are adequate. (3 points).

conclusion: This is a retrospective cohort, despite collecting the information after the event. (3 points).

8. (6 points) Authored replacement for source item Question 8: Solve this case and explain your reasoning: Six cases have onset on day 1, eight on day 2, and two on day 3. Their report dates are all day 5.

reasoning: An onset curve has three bins with counts 6, 8, and 2.
A report-date curve would incorrectly look like 16 simultaneous reports if interpreted as onset.
Use onset timing to generate source hypotheses and assess completeness before claiming the source. (3 points).

conclusion: The time variable changes the meaning of the curve. (3 points).

repair-case. (4 points) Authored written substitute for unavailable source material: Why not compute risk from an ordinary case-control sample fraction?

Unit: Identifying study designs.
Worked-case data: Investigators interview every attendee on a banquet roster after an outbreak and compare illness by food consumed. Identify the design.

answer: Investigators choose case/control numbers; those fractions do not represent source-population disease occurrence. (4 points).